09 Nov 2026 11:21:52 ET | 13 pages

Simplo Technology (6121.TWO)

An Established Battery Franchise with Room for a Better Mix

CITI'S TAKE

3Q26 EPS missed our/BBG estimates by 35%/30% each as notebook pull-ins faded and low yields on a major US customer's new smartphone held back shipments. We expect higher PC component costs to keep IT demand subdued in 1Q27E, while rising contribution from AES could still help margin expansion in 2027E. We lower 2026-2028E EPS by 17-20% and revise our TP to NT$400 based on 12x 2027E EPS, lowered from 13x reflecting weaker visibility on IT recovery. We continue to favor Simplo's leading market share in notebook/smartphone battery franchises and its exposure to AIDC BBU growth through AES.

3Q earnings -17% y/y missed our/BBG estimates by 35%/30% on weaker IT shipments — 3Q26 sales of NT$19.9bn fell 2% y/y and 5% q/q, 13%/10% below our/BBG forecasts. Notebook customers pulled orders into 1H26 amid rising memory prices, while lower yields on a major US customer's new smartphone constrained 3Q shipment. Group GPM rose 0.7ppt y/y to 16.3% on a larger AES contribution. However, standalone GPM dropped 1.6ppt y/y 50 9.2% on higher input costs and lower volumes. Group OPM rose 0.4ppt y/y to 9.7%, lower than our (12.2%) and BBG (11.9%) estimates. Higher taxes also weighed on EPS.

2027E outlook stays muted for IT — The mgmt. expects IT demand to remain lukewarm in 1Q27E as higher component costs put upward pressure on PC prices likely weighing on demand. Standalone sales are expected to be flat to slightly down y/y in 2027E, with the group sales flat to slightly up on AES's BBU growth. Mgmt. notes the battery-pack inventories at notebook brands are lean at just a few weeks and easing cobalt prices could bring down ASP in 2027E. A new non-IT product line is growing severalfold from a small base, and the mgmt. expects it to make up >5% in 2028E with a GPM above group's average.

Implications — We cut 2026-2028E earnings estimates 17-20% for 2026-2028E reflecting 3Q miss and a slower IT recovery, resulting in a 10-18% cut on our sales forecasts. We lower our TP to NT$400 based on a target P/E of 12x from 13x on 2027E EPS, reflecting the component inflation likely delaying the timing of IT recovery. We stay Buy on Simplo's established notebook and smartphone battery franchises and AES's exposure to growing datacenter BBU demand. AI PC adoption could lift battery-pack ASPs over time, and an estimated 6% dividend yield should help cushion downside.

Buy

Price (09 Nov 26 15:00)	NT$349.00
Target price	NT$400.00↓
from NT$480.00	
Expected share price return	14.6%
Expected dividend yield	6.2%
Expected total return	20.8%
Market Cap	NT$64,555M
	US$1,969M

Price Performance
(RIC: 6121.TWO, BB: 6121 TT)



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Earnings Summary

Year to 31 Dec	Net Profit (NT$M)	Diluted EPS (NT$)	EPS growth (%)	P/E (x)	P/B (x)	ROE (%)	Yield (%)
2024A	5,342	28.88	-5.8	12.1	1.8	15.1	5.9
2025A	5,586	30.20	4.6	11.6	1.7	14.9	6.2
2026E	5,331	28.82	-4.6	12.1	1.7	13.9	6.0
2027E	6,308	34.10	18.3	10.2	1.6	16.1	7.1
2028E	7,156	38.68	13.4	9.0	1.5	17.1	na

Source: Powered by dataCentral

6121.TWO: Fiscal year end 31-Dec						Price: NT$349.00; TP: NT$400.00; Market Cap: NT$64,555m; Recomm: Buy					
Profit & Loss (NT$m)	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**	**Valuation ratios**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
Sales revenue	80,031	82,150	77,698	75,318	82,630	PE (x)	12.1	11.6	12.1	10.2	9.0
Cost of sales	-68,696	-69,461	-64,351	-61,143	-66,425	PB (x)	1.8	1.7	1.7	1.6	1.5
Gross profit	11,335	12,688	13,347	14,175	16,205	EV/EBITDA (x)	4.3	3.6	3.0	2.0	1.6
Gross Margin (%)	14.2	15.4	17.2	18.8	19.6	FCF yield (%)	6.4	3.7	25.7	11.8	15.5
EBITDA (Adj)	**8,962**	**10,208**	**10,917**	**13,022**	**15,007**	Dividend yield (%)	5.9	6.2	6.0	7.1	na
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	11.2	12.4	14.1	17.3	18.2	Payout ratio (%)	71	72	72	72	0
Depreciation	-2,540	-2,481	-2,721	-3,093	-3,461	ROE (%)	15.1	14.9	13.9	16.1	17.1
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0	**Cashflow (NT$m)**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
EBIT (Adj)	**6,422**	**7,727**	**8,196**	**9,929**	**11,545**	EBITDA	8,962	10,208	10,917	13,022	15,007
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	8.0	9.4	10.5	13.2	14.0	Working capital	-3,228	-3,673	9,855	-898	-167
Net interest	1,320	1,193	1,061	1,090	1,200	Other	610	-608	-932	-1,319	-1,605
Associates	-2	5	68	23	24	**Operating cashflow**	**6,344**	**5,928**	**19,840**	**10,805**	**13,235**
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	365	351	478	301	331	Capex	-2,233	-3,568	-3,242	-3,200	-3,200
Pre-tax profit	**8,106**	**9,276**	**9,803**	**11,344**	**13,100**	Net acq/disposals	0	0	0	0	0
Tax	-1,783	-2,214	-2,539	-2,734	-3,159	Other	3,370	2,147	928	-23	-24
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	-981	-1,475	-1,933	-2,302	-2,785	**Investing cashflow**	**1,137**	**-1,421**	**-2,313**	**-3,223**	**-3,224**
Reported net profit	**5,342**	**5,586**	**5,331**	**6,308**	**7,156**	Dividends paid	-4,014	-3,792	-4,032	-3,848	-4,554
Net Margin (%)	6.7	6.8	6.9	8.4	8.7	**Financing cashflow**	**-5,899**	**-3,474**	**-6,241**	**-3,848**	**-4,554**
Core NPAT	5,342	5,586	5,331	6,308	7,156	**Net change in cash**	**2,801**	**854**	**11,286**	**3,734**	**5,458**
Per share data	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**	**Free cashflow to s/holders**	**4,111**	**2,360**	**16,598**	**7,605**	**10,035**
Reported EPS ($)	28.88	30.20	28.82	34.10	38.68						
Core EPS ($)	28.88	30.20	28.82	34.10	38.68						
DPS ($)	20.51	21.80	20.80	24.62	0						
CFPS ($)	34.30	32.05	107.26	58.42	71.55						
FCFPS ($)	22.22	12.76	89.74	41.12	54.25						
BVPS ($)	198.75	207.54	205.78	219.08	233.14						
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	185	185	185	185	185						
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	185	185	185	185	185						
Growth rates	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**						
Sales revenue (%)	-5.6	2.6	-5.4	-3.1	9.7						
EBIT (Adj) (%)	-7.5	20.3	6.1	21.1	16.3						
Core NPAT (%)	-5.8	4.6	-4.6	18.3	13.4						
Core EPS (%)	-5.8	4.6	-4.6	18.3	13.4						
Balance Sheet (NT$m)	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**						
Cash & cash equiv.	34,004	34,858	46,144	49,877	55,334						
Accounts receivables	15,121	15,898	11,295	12,360	13,449						
Inventory	14,211	16,692	13,111	14,346	15,610						
Net fixed & other tangibles	12,596	13,974	6,317	6,425	6,163						
Goodwill & intangibles	116	169	169	169	169						
Financial & other assets	2,293	1,911	1,439	1,526	1,614						
Total assets	**78,339**	**83,501**	**78,476**	**84,704**	**92,339**						
Accounts payable	19,509	22,408	16,150	16,678	17,969						
Short-term debt	449	943	415	415	415						
Long-term debt	0	0	72	72	72						
Provisions & other liab	14,948	14,149	14,731	15,668	16,627						
Total liabilities	**34,906**	**37,500**	**31,368**	**32,833**	**35,083**						
Shareholders' equity	36,763	38,389	38,062	40,523	43,124						
Minority interests	6,670	7,612	9,046	11,348	14,133						
Total equity	**43,433**	**46,001**	**47,108**	**51,870**	**57,256**						
Net debt (Adj)	**-33,554**	**-33,915**	**-45,657**	**-49,380**	**-54,847**						
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	-77.3	-73.7	-96.9	-95.2	-95.8						

For definitions of the items in this table, please click here.

Figure 1. Simplo: 3Q26 Results Comp

NT$mn	3Q26 Actual	2Q26 Actual	Q/Q	3Q25 Actual	Y/Y	3Q26 Citi	Diff.	3Q26 Cons.	Diff.
Revenue	**19,906**	**20,917**	**-5%**	**20,394**	**-2%**	**22,877**	**-13%**	**22,171**	**-10%**
Gross profit	3,252	3,827	-15%	3,197	2%	4,067	-20%	3,990	-18%
Gross margin (%)	*16.3%*	*18.3%*	*-2.0*	*15.7%*	*0.7*	*17.8%*	*-1.4*	*18.0%*	*-1.7*
Op. profit	**1,931**	**2,486**	**-22%**	**1,903**	**1%**	**2,786**	**-31%**	**2,641**	**-27%**
OP margin (%)	*9.7%*	*11.9%*	*-2.2*	*9.3%*	*0.4*	*12.2%*	*-2.5*	*11.9%*	*-2.2*
Pre-tax profit	2,385	2,918	-18%	2,330	2%	3,100	-23%	2,944	-19%
Net income	**1,213**	**1,675**	**-28%**	**1,457**	**-17%**	**1,873**	**-35%**	**1,725**	**-30%**
EPS (NT$)	**6.56**	**9.06**	**-28%**	**7.87**	**-17%**	**10.13**	**-35%**	**9.33**	**-30%**

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Source: Company Reports, Bloomberg, Citi Research, Citi Research Estimates

Figure 2. Simplo: Earnings Estimates Revision

(NT$mn)	New	Old	Chg.	New	Old	Chg.	New	Old	Chg.
Sales	77,698	86,022	-10%	75,318	92,343	-18%	82,630	100,875	-18%
Gross profit	13,347	15,260	-13%	14,175	16,903	-16%	16,205	18,998	-15%
Opex	5,151	5,274	-2%	4,245	5,197	-18%	4,661	5,670	-18%
Operating profit	8,196	9,986	-18%	9,929	11,706	-15%	11,544	13,328	-13%
Pre-tax profit	9,803	11,352	-14%	11,344	13,237	-14%	13,099	15,017	-13%
Net income	5,331	6,641	-20%	6,308	7,737	-18%	7,155	8,607	-17%
EPS (NT$)	28.82	35.90	-20%	34.10	41.83	-18%	38.68	46.53	-17%
Gross margin	17.2%	17.7%	-0.56	18.8%	18.3%	0.51	19.6%	18.8%	0.78
Opex ratio	6.6%	6.1%	0.50	5.6%	5.6%	0.01	5.6%	5.6%	0.02
Operating margin	10.5%	11.6%	-1.06	13.2%	12.7%	0.51	14.0%	13.2%	0.76
Net margin	6.9%	7.7%	-0.86	8.4%	8.4%	0.00	8.7%	8.5%	0.13

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Source: Citi Research, Citi Research Estimates

Bull/Bear: Simplo Technology (6121.TWO)

NT$ 500.00 ▲43% Upside | NT$ 400.00 ▲15% Upside | NT$ 270.00 ▼23% Downside



Spread 66pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 09 Nov 2026

BULL Assumptions

- Higher target multiple at 16x

BASE Assumptions

- Sales to decline by 5% y-o-y growth in 2026E
- OPM at 10-11% in 2026E
- Target multiple at 12x

BEAR Assumptions

- Lower target multiple at 9x

Simplo Technology

Company description

Established in 1992, Simplo specializes in designing and producing battery packs for Notebooks, tablet PC, and electronic vehicle products. With strong execution and cost advantages, Simplo continues to broaden its client base. Its major customers include PC OEMs (such as HPQ, Dell, Asus, Acer, and Apple) and NB ODMs (such as Quanta, Compal, Wistron, and Inventec).

Investment strategy

We rate Simplo shares as Buy. Simplo's heating fundamentals are driven by the following reasons. 1) Japan supplier's strategy change on focusing EV battery pack and de-prioritizing NB which provides Simplo more orders wins; and 2) Non-IT: according to our industry survey, Simplo has been qualified by global ISPs for the battery back units (BBU) for their data centers.

Valuation

Our target price of NT$400 is based on a target P/E of 12x 2027E EPS, on par with its historical average since 2010.

Risks

Downside risks that may cause the shares to continue to trade below our target price include: 1) weaker than expected end product sales; 2) intensified competition; and 3) worse-than-expected overall NB/tablet/PC growth.

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Appendix A-1

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Simplo Technology (6121.TWO)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Angela Hsu



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	01-Feb-24 22:43:18	1	*432.00	389.50
2	18-Mar-24 17:05:16	1	*538.00	471.00
3	09-May-24 08:32:34	1	*505.00	402.00
4	30-Aug-24 05:24:59	1	*495.00	371.00
5	27-Aug-25 03:29:05	1	*480.00	393.50

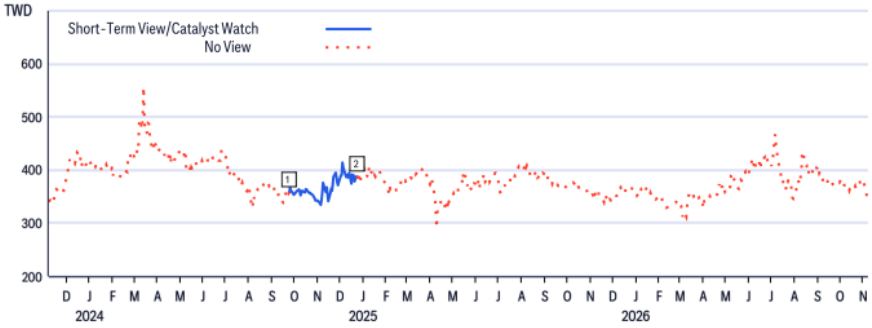
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Simplo Technology (6121.TWO)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Angela Hsu



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	24-Sep-24 03:29:20	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	358.00
2	23-Dec-24 20:28:13	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	388.00

CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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